

SOH FINAL EXAM REVIEW GUIDE, SPRING 2019

All of these concepts are IMPORTANT, and you should be able to explain each item, and its characteristics or examples (as relevant):

1. PERMA, and the theory behind it

The PERMA model was designed by Martin Seligman, founder of positive psychology, with five core element of psychological well-being and happiness (P-Positive Emotion, E-Engagement, R-Relationships, M-Meaning, A-Accomplishments) that leads to a life of fulfillment, happiness, and meaning.

2. The main figures of the positive psychology movement

Martin Seligman, Christopher Peterson, coauthored book, *character strengths and virtues*; Albert Bandura, self-efficacy theory; Barbara Fredrickson, positive emotions.

3. Positive emotions/ positive priming:

Priming is a technique whereby exposure to one stimulus influences a response to a subsequent stimulus, without conscious guidance or intention. Positive priming affects the speed of processing and is thought to be caused by spreading activation. This means that the first stimulus activates parts of a particular representation or association in memory just before carrying out an action or task. Positive priming was studied by asking subjects their willingness to drive recklessly after exposure to a positive (priming) affect: a positive mood story; happy memories; an exciting film; a relaxing film; or thoughts on the meaning in life. Following the prime, the participants were asked to report on their willingness to drive recklessly. Positive emotions of a relaxing nature, as well as thinking about the meaning in life, lowered the willingness to engage in risky driving.

4. Growth vs fixed mindsets

A growth mindset is the understanding that abilities and understanding can be developed. Those with a growth mindset believe that they can get smarter, more intelligent, and more talented through putting in time and effort. A fixed mindset is one that assumes abilities and understanding are relatively fixed. Those with a fixed mindset may not believe that intelligence can be enhanced, or that you either have it or you don't when it comes to abilities and talents. The main difference between the two mindsets is the belief in the permanence of intelligence and ability; one views it as very permanent, with little to no room for change in either direction, while the other views it as more changeable, with opportunities for improvement (or, for that matter, regression).

5. Willpower

We rely on willpower to exercise, diet, save money, quit smoking, stop drinking, overcome procrastination, and ultimately accomplish any of our goals. It impacts every area of our lives. People use different definitions to describe willpower, but some of the most common synonyms are: drive, determination, self-discipline, self-control, self-regulation, effortful control. At the core of willpower is the ability to

resist short-term temptations and desires in order to achieve long-term goals. *It's the prevailing source of long-term satisfaction over instant gratification.*

6. Deliberate practice

Deliberate practice refers to a special type of practice that is purposeful and systematic. While regular practice might include mindless repetitions, deliberate practice requires focused attention and is conducted with the specific goal of improving performance. It is the act of rehearsing a behavior over and over, or engaging in an activity again and again, for the purpose of improving or mastering it, as in the phrase practice makes perfect. Behavioral theory would argue that deliberate practice is facilitated by feedback from an expert that allows for successful approximation of the target performance

7. Maximizing vs. satisficing.

Satisficing are individuals who are pleased to settle for a good enough option, not necessarily the very best outcome in all respects. A satisficer is less likely to experience regret even if a better option presents itself after a decision has already been made. Compared to satisficers, maximizing individuals are more likely to experience lower levels of happiness, regret, and self-esteem. They also tend to be perfectionist.

8. Broaden-and-build vs. narrow-and-constrict

The broaden-and-build theory refers to subsets of positive emotions, including joy, interest, contentment and love. A key proposition is that these positive emotions broaden an individual's momentary thought-action repertoire: joy sparks the urge to play, interest sparks the urge to explore, contentment sparks the urge to savour and integrate, and love sparks a recurring cycle of each of these urges within safe, close relationships. The broadened mindsets arising from these positive emotions are contrasted to the narrowed mindsets sparked by many negative emotions (i.e. specific action tendencies, such as attack or flee).

9. Benefits of sleep on mental health (and barriers)

Sleep is essential to the maintenance of mental health. Sleep helps to regulate mood and process emotional information and experiences into memory. Insufficient sleep is associated with increased emotional reactivity and emotional disturbance. Sleep problems occur substantially more frequently in people with psychiatric conditions than in the general population. Often, sleep and mental health disorders exist in bi-directional relationship to each other, with each condition influencing the other. Poor sleep can contribute to the onset and severity of mental health disorders, and mental health problems can create and exacerbate sleep issues. Treating sleep problems may deliver therapeutic help for mental health conditions, just as sleep may

improve as mental health disorders are treated. Your bedroom should be cool, dark and quiet. Avoid placing a television or computer in your room, as the light and sound close to bedtime could make it difficult to fall asleep. If possible, keep your cell phone in another room throughout the night

10. Benefits of nutrition on mental health

Nutrition has been implicated in behavior, mood and in the pathology and treatment of mental illness. The more one eats a Western or highly processed diet, the more one is at risk for developing psychiatric symptoms, such as depression and anxiety. Conversely, the more one eats a Mediterranean-style diet, the more one is protected from developing a mental disorder. The bidirectional communication between the gut microbiota and the brain has been shown to influence neurotransmission and the behavior that is often associated with neuropsychiatric conditions, and likewise the microbiome has been associated with multiple systemic pathologies and obesity. A good example is the effect of gluten allergy on the brain in Celiac disease.

11. Benefits of exercise on mental health

There is a growing body of literature that recognizes the positive effects of exercise on mood states such as anxiety, stress and depression, through physiological and biochemical mechanisms, including endorphins, neurotransmitters, and the hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis that secretes the stress hormone cortisol. Exercise reduces inflammation via several different processes (inflammation, cytokines, toll-like receptors, adipose tissue and via the vagal tone), which can contribute to better health outcomes in people suffering from mood disorders.

12. Epworth sleepiness scale

Excessive daytime sleepiness is the most common complaint reported in sleep clinics. It is defined as an inability to stay awake and alert during the major waking periods of the day causing unintentional lapses into drowsiness or sleep occurring on a daily basis for more than 3 months. The Epworth Sleepiness Scale (ESS) is a widely used scale for daytime sleepiness in adults. It is a simple, self-administered questionnaire which is shown to provide a measurement of the subject's general level of daytime sleepiness.

13. Sleep hygiene

Sleep hygiene is defined as a set of behavioral and environmental recommendations intended to promote healthy sleep, and was originally developed for use in the treatment of mild to moderate insomnia. During sleep hygiene education, patients learn about healthy sleep habits and are encouraged to follow a set of recommendations to improve their sleep (e.g., avoid caffeine, exercise regularly, eliminate noise from the sleeping environment, maintain a regular sleep schedule).

14. Circadian rhythm

The most studied biological rhythm is the circadian rhythm, with a period close to 24 h. When an organism remains in a constant environment (constant darkness, constant temperature) for a prolonged interval, almost all physiological activities oscillate with a period close to, but still different from, 24 h. In humans, there are circadian rhythms in body temperature, cardiac, pulmonary and metabolic activity, nervous system activity of many areas of the brain, the secretion of all hormones, such as melatonin or cortisol, and the sleep-wake cycle. Circadian rhythms can be observed in the performance of most tasks and activities recorded thus far in humans, such as sensory, motor, reaction time, time estimation, memory tasks, verbal tasks, arithmetic calculations, and simulated driving tasks. Performance increases during the day and decreases during the night.

15. Stress and eating chart

16. Comfort food, effects

Comfort foods are typically energy-dense, high fat and sweet, such as chocolate, ice cream, and French fries. They give distinctive pleasure or make us temporarily feel better. Feeling good (high in fat, sugar or salt) activates the brain's reward system. Comfort food as self-medication (A phenomenon called emotional eating. In a bad mood, people are drawn to unhealthy foods (eating sugary and fatty) as a coping mechanism. In contrast, people in a positive mood tend to choose healthy foods). The need to belong. We tend to associate certain foods with members of our family, social gatherings, and people taking care of us (Thanksgiving holidays with family). So when we feel lonely we crave for these foods to give us comfort and security. Nostalgic eating (There is a strong link between scents and emotional memory. Smell of foods can evoke vivid and detailed emotional memories of our past). Special occasion (We tend to go for special, often unhealthy, foods on celebratory occasions, like birthdays or Thanksgiving).

17. The Freshman 15

The "freshman 15" is an expression that refers to the amount of weight gained during a student's first year at college. The causes of this weight gain are increased alcohol intake and the consumption of fat and carbohydrate-rich cafeteria-style food in university dormitories and fast food in nearby restaurants. Many other causes include malnutrition, stress, and decreased levels of exercise

18. The downsides of sitting too much

Affects blood circulation, leads to bad posture, excess body fat, reduced lung efficiency, tiredness in back and neck muscles, poor digestion, eye strain.

19. BDNF

Brain-derived neurotrophic factor, also known as BDNF, is a protein that, in humans, is encoded by the BDNF Gene. BDNF acts on certain

neurons of the central nervous system and the peripheral nervous system, helping to support the survival of existing neurons, and encourage the growth and differentiation of new neurons and synapses.

20. Difference between how exercise and sleep affect your brain cells

Exercise does more than grow your brain, done at the right time it improves your memory. Sleep also allows you to create new memories, organize old ones, and develop. It is associated with better judgement, eating habits, focus, learning, attention and willpower.

21. Hedonic treadmill

The hedonic treadmill, also known as hedonic adaptation, is the observed tendency of humans to quickly return to a relatively stable level of happiness despite major positive or negative events or life changes. According to this theory, as a person makes more money, expectations and desires rise in tandem, which results in no permanent gain in happiness.

22. Set point theory

The set-point theory of happiness suggests that our level of subjective well-being is determined primarily by heredity and by personality traits ingrained in us early in life, and as a result remains relatively constant throughout our lives. Our level of happiness may change transiently in response to life events, but then almost always returns to its baseline level as we habituate to those events and their consequences over time.

23. Empirically sound interventions that can change your set point

How can an individual increase his or her baseline level of happiness for a sustained period of time? Committing Acts of Kindness, Expressing Gratitude and Optimism, Processing Unhappy and Happy Life Experiences, and positive behavioral activities that involve the enhancement of psychological resilience, defined as the ability to recover from negative emotional experiences.

24. Flow

In positive psychology, flow, also known colloquially as being *in the zone*, is the mental state of operation in which a person performing an activity is fully immersed in a feeling of energized focus, full involvement, and enjoyment in the process of the activity. Flow is linked to the development of skills and higher levels of performance and greater positive emotion and life satisfaction.

25. ACR chart

Active and constructive responding (ACR) refers to one of four ways in which we respond to good news; it is part of a theoretical framework proposed by psychologist Shelly Gable. Active and constructive responding is the most effective way to respond, giving both the deliverer of good news and the listener a positive outcome. (The other

three ways include passive and constructive, active and destructive, and passive and destructive.



26. Optimistic explanatory style vs pessimistic explanatory style components

Optimists explain positive events in terms of personal, permanent causes and negative events in terms of external, temporary causes. An optimistic explanatory style is associated with higher levels of motivation, achievement, and physical well-being and lower levels of depressive symptoms. Pessimists have the opposite explanatory style. They personally blame themselves for bad events and perceive the root cause to be a fixed factor. When something good happens, they tend to attribute it to luck and see the cause as temporary. Individuals with pessimistic explanatory styles are more likely to experience pervasive and chronic symptoms of helplessness when faced with uncontrollable negative events. Maladaptive thought patterns can fuel issues such as depression by creating a cycle of negative thought that perpetuates the problem.

27. Nun study

Handwritten autobiographies from 180 Catholic nuns, composed when participants were a mean age of 22 years, were scored for emotional content and related to survival during ages 75 to 95. A strong inverse association was found between positive emotional content in these writings and risk of mortality in late life ($p < .001$). As the quartile ranking of positive emotion in early life increased, there was a stepwise decrease in risk of mortality resulting in a 2.5-fold difference between the lowest and highest quartiles. Positive emotional content in early-life autobiographies was strongly associated with longevity 6

decades later. Authentically happy lives primarily stem from creating purpose and meaning in our lives, as well as making sure we engage in activities that positively absorb our attention. It's here that we're likely to experience being "in the zone," which can be seen, for example, when pianists get caught up in the music they play.

28. Pittsburgh Common Cold study

Pittsburgh Cold Study 1 (PCS1) was a prospective viral challenge study conducted from 1993-1996 among healthy volunteers ages 18-55 studying the relation between psychological stress and common cold susceptibility. After completing baseline psychosocial questionnaires and biological assessments, participants were administered nasal drops containing either rhinovirus 39 (RV39; n=147) or rhinovirus 21 (RV21; n=129). They were then followed in quarantine for 5 days and monitored for development of infection and objective signs of illness. That study found a dose-response relationship between stress and susceptibility to colds: Every increment in stress was associated with increased risk of developing a cold"

29. Chocolate-and-Radish experiment

Researchers examined the effect of a tempting food challenge designed to deplete participants' willpower through the awful power of an unfulfilled promise of chocolate. In the first part of the trial, study participants in a room smelled freshly baked chocolate. The experimental subjects were asked to eat radishes instead. Many of the radish-eaters exhibited clear interest in the chocolates, to the point of looking longingly at the chocolate display. After the food bait-and-switch, the participants were given a second, supposedly unrelated exercise, a persistence-testing puzzle. The effect of the manipulation was immediate and undeniable. *Those who ate radishes made far fewer attempts and devoted less than half the time solving the puzzle compared to the chocolate-eating participants and a control group that only joined this latter phase of the study. In other words, those who had to resist the sweets and force themselves to eat pungent vegetables could no longer find the will to fully engage in another torturous task. They were already too tired.*

30. Marshmallow study

This was a study on delayed gratification in which a child was offered a choice between one small reward, provided immediately or two small rewards if they waited for a short period, approximately 15 minutes, during which the tester left the room and then returned. The reward was sometimes a marshmallow, but often a cookie or a pretzel. In follow-up studies, the researchers found that children who were able to wait longer for the preferred rewards tended to have better life outcomes, as measured by SAT scores, educational attainment, body mass index (BMI), and other life measures. A replication attempt with a more diverse sample population over 10 times larger than the original

study failed to support the original study's conclusions and suggested that economic background rather than willpower explained the results.

31. Fiji study

Harvard Medical School psychiatrist Anne E. Becker was still an undergraduate at Radcliffe when she traveled to Fiji for a summer of anthropology fieldwork. What struck her about this South Pacific island nation was the absolute preoccupation with food and eating. Becker oversaw a 1995-98 study that measured the effect of television on cultural norms. The results were startling. In 1995, without television, girls in Fiji appeared to be free of the eating disorders common in the West. But by 1998, after just a few years of sexy soap operas and seductive commercials, 11.3 percent of adolescent girls reported they at least once had purged to lose weight. Becker's study revealed a dissonance between the reality of the girls' lives (poor and agrarian) and their expectations (rich and cosmopolitan). Nearly 80 percent of the girls said they planned on professional careers. That included being an airline hostess. "They only want thin girls," one respondent said.

32. Naperville Zero Hour study

Naperville is a town near Chicago and the subject of a fascinating experiment written about by psychiatrist Dr. John Ratey in his groundbreaking book, *Spark*. The gym teachers at Naperville conducted an educational experiment called Zero Hour P.E. where they scheduled time to work out before class using treadmills and other exercise equipment where you are only competing against yourself to improve. This program not only turned their 19,000 students into the fittest in the nation but also, in some categories, the smartest in the world. There is almost no brain function that exercise doesn't affect in a positive way. Exercise helped them concentrate better and learn better—particularly exercise that involves structured movement like martial arts.

33. Yerkes-Dodson Law and the value of stress

Yerkes-Dodson law suggests that elevated arousal levels can improve performance up to a certain point. The law was first described in 1908 by psychologists Robert Yerkes and John Dillingham Dodson. They discovered that mild electrical shocks could be used to motivate rats to complete a maze, but when the electrical shocks became too strong, the rats would scurry around in random directions to escape. The experiment demonstrated that increasing stress and arousal levels could help focus motivation and attention on the task at hand, but only up to a certain point. The anxiety you experience before an exam is one example of how the Yerkes-Dodson Law operates. An optimal level of stress can help you focus on the test and remember the information that you studied; too much test anxiety can impair your ability to concentrate and make it more difficult to remember the correct answers. Athletic performance offers another great example of the Yerkes-Dodson Law. When a player is poised to make an important

move, like making a basket during a basketball game, an ideal level of arousal can sharpen his performance and enable him to make the shot. When a player gets too stressed out, he might instead "choke" and miss the shot.

34. Mismatch theory

The human suite of psychological mechanisms evolved during the period of human

History when people likely lived as hunter-gatherers in small kin-based groups in African savannas and later in Asia and Europe. The seeds for present-day evolutionary mismatch were sewn roughly 10,000 years ago when agriculture arose and humans began living in

contexts diverging from their hunter-gatherer past. Modern people are increasingly facing physical and mental health issues rarely found in current hunter gatherer societies (which model those of our ancestral past). A common hijack mismatch occurs with food choices. Sweet tastes in ancestral environments were associated with foods such as fruit, yams, and honey that have naturally useful levels of carbohydrates and

nutrients. Accordingly, a decision rule of "prefer and eat the sweetest-tasting things" led to beneficial consumption of such foods. Today, however, the sweetest tastes belong to readily available foods manufactured with copious amounts of processed sugars and stripped of nutrients (Fig. 1b). These mismatched food sources then lead to illnesses such as diabetes because physiological mechanisms involving insulin and glucagon did not evolve to repeatedly metabolize unnaturally large amounts of sugar. As societies globalize and human-induced environmental change occurs progressively faster, evolutionary mismatch is only becoming increasingly prevalent.

35. PTSD/PTG/Resilience

Post-traumatic growth (PTG) is defined as the positive psychological change experienced as a result of the struggle with highly challenging life circumstances. It is natural to assume that PTG, by definition, would show a negative correlation with posttraumatic stress disorder (PTSD). In regards to the relationship between PTG and resilience, where the latter has generally been defined as stress coping ability in the face of adversity, scientists have proposed the model of psychological preparedness, in which it is posited that PTG would help survivors to be less traumatized by subsequent tragedies. The notion of psychological preparedness coincides with that of the stress inoculation model or vaccination, in which exposure to moderate stress serves as a protection against subsequent stressors. Following this model, PTG should show a positive correlation with resilience.

However, the fact that PTG can correlate positively with both PTSD and resilience is very interesting, because a negative correlation between PTSD and resilience is obvious. In MVA survivors, some factors of PTG, such as personal strength, relating to others, and new possibility, were

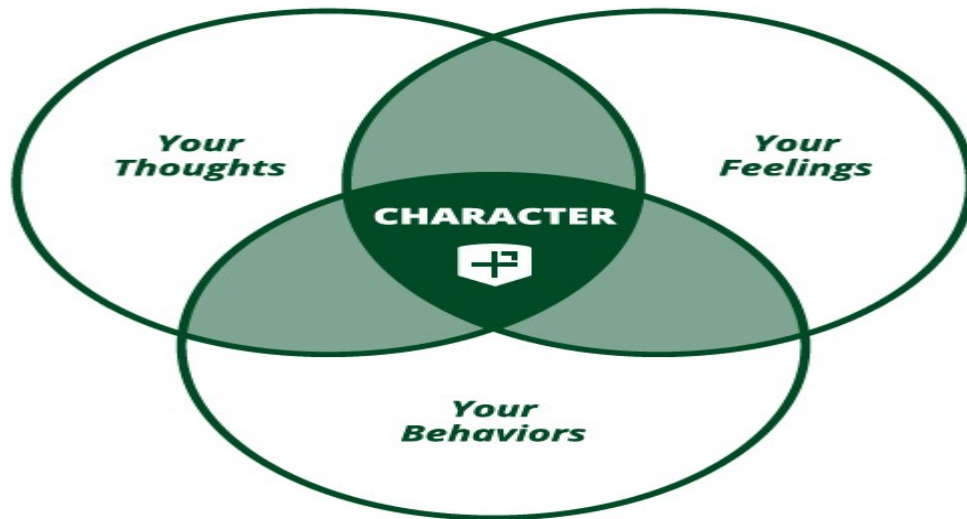
positively correlated with resilience, whereas other factors such as appreciation of life and spiritual change, were positively correlated with PTSD symptoms. These findings contribute to our understanding of the psychological change experienced by MVA survivors, and to raising clinicians' awareness of the possibility that PTG represents coping effort coexisting with distress and the outcome of coping success.

36. Tetris Effect

The Tetris effect (also known as Tetris syndrome) occurs when people devote so much time and attention to an activity that it begins to pattern their thoughts, mental images, and dreams. It takes its name from the video game Tetris. People who played Tetris for a prolonged amount of time could find themselves thinking about ways different shapes in the real world can fit together, such as the boxes on a supermarket shelf, the buildings on a street, or hallucinating pieces being generated and falling into place on an invisible layout. In this sense, the Tetris effect is a form of habit. They might also dream about falling tetrominos when drifting off to sleep or see images of falling tetrominos at the edges of their visual fields or when they close their eyes. In this sense, the Tetris effect is a form of hypnagogic imagery. On a perceptual level, sea legs are a kind of Tetris effect. A person newly on land after spending long periods at sea may sense illusory rocking motion, having become accustomed to the constant work of adjusting to the boat making such movements. A study showed that participants who played Tetris for twelve 30-minute sessions (with no previous experience of the game) did much better than the control group in both the paper-pencil test version of spatial skills as well as the computerized version. The conclusions drawn from this experiments were that video games such as Tetris had a positive effect on three areas of spatial skills including mental rotation, spatial perception and spatial visualization in those who played for a prolonged period continuously.

37. Character strengths

Character is more than simply individual achievement or a person's behavior. It is a broad and complex family of thoughts, feelings, and behaviors that are recognized and encouraged across cultures for the values they cultivate in people and society. Character is the aggregate of who we are; it's "what's inside every one of us." Dr. Chris Peterson took a three-year sabbatical to better understand character and its manifestations. Alongside Dr. Martin Seligman, Dr. Peterson then wrote an 800-page book on the research called Character Strengths and Virtues. This book explains that: 24 character strengths that are evident in the most widely influential traditions of thought in human history. All 24 character strengths exist in every individual, ranging from bravery and forgiveness to integrity and gratitude, these character strengths are the foundation of The Positivity Project's model.



38. Three steps for signature strengths

This intervention has three steps: take the VIA Survey (the VIA Survey of Character Strengths is a simple self-assessment that takes less than 15 minutes and provides a wealth of information to help you understand your core characteristics; identify one of your signature strengths, and use it in a new way each day. Seligman describes in his book “Authentic Happiness” how he and Peterson set out to identify values that were pervasive across time and cultures around the globe. They found a surprising amount of overlap in the virtues that are considered fundamental to each culture. Each virtue is characterized by specific character strengths, twenty-four in total, and can be achieved by exercising these strengths. For instance, displaying love, kindness and social intelligence lead to the virtue of “humanity.” These strengths are often ingrained in rituals, stories, and parables, as well as institutions. In randomized, controlled trials, this intervention consistently leads to increases in happiness and decreases in depression, sometimes with effects lasting six months. This exercise has been further validated by revealing benefits across a number of populations, including youth, older adults, employees, people with traumatic brain injuries, suicidal people, as well as in various locations such as China, Australia, UK, USA, Canada, and Europe. The use of 4 or more signature strengths at work is a cutoff for more positive work experience and work-as-a-calling.

39. Why to say “I’m excited” rather than “calm down”

Next time you’ve got a public speaking engagement or exam coming up, psych yourself up by telling yourself how excited you are, rather than trying to calm down, and you may actually perform better. That’s according to a new Harvard study published by the American Psychological Association, which found that affirmative statements like “I’m excited” helped people improve their performance compared to self-pep talks that urged relaxation such as “I am calm”. People have a

very strong intuition that trying to calm down is the best way to cope with their anxiety, but that can be very difficult and ineffective. When people feel anxious and try to calm down, they are thinking about all the things that could go badly. When they are excited, they are thinking about how things could go well.”

40. Qualities of goal-setting

Research into goal setting has culminated in the theory of goal setting and task performance in which 5 key principles for successful goal achievement are suggested:

Commitment (how attached you are to the goal); clarity (precise and unambiguous goals); challenge (challenging but attainable); task complexity (overly complex tasks mute goal setting); and feedback (more effective in the presence of immediate feedback).

41. Prevention vs promotion goals

People who see their goals as opportunities for gain or advancement are focused on the great things that will happen for them when they succeed – the benefits and rewards. They “play to win.” When people pursue this kind of “good,” we call it having a promotion focus. Unfortunately, all that chance-taking and positive-thinking makes them more prone to error, less likely to completely think things through, and usually unprepared with a Plan B in case things fail. For a promotion-focused person, what’s really “bad” is a non-gain: a chance not taken, a reward unearned, a failure to advance.

Others, see their goals as opportunities to meet their responsibilities and to stay safe. They consider what might go badly if they don’t work hard enough to achieve. They don’t play to win – they play to not lose. They want, more than anything else, to feel secure. When people pursue this kind of “good,” they have what we call a prevention focus. In our studies, we find the prevention-focused to be more driven by criticism and the looming possibility of failure (if, for example, they don’t work hard enough) than by applause and a sunny outlook. Prevention-focused people are often more conservative and don’t take chances, but their work is also more thorough, accurate, and carefully-planned. Of course, too much caution and hypervigilance for error pretty much kills off any potential for growth, creativity, and innovation. But for the prevention-focused, the ultimate “bad” is a loss you failed to stop: a mistake made, a punishment received, a danger you failed to avoid. They would much prefer to say No! to an opportunity, rather than end up in hot water.

42. Definition of meaning, and when the search for meaning most occurs in a lifespan

Michael Steger suggests that meaning provokes us with three foundational principles: Our lives matter, our lives make sense, and we have a purpose or a basis for our aspirations and pursuits in life. These principles can be applied to college: finding meaning *makes sense* of your life, which internship to choose, which extracurricular activities,

and which friends to spend time with. When you commit to something that is not feeling quite right, check your meaning meter and you'll find it dipping low.

43. Operant conditioning chart

Operant conditioning (also called instrumental conditioning) is a learning process through which the strength of a behavior is modified by reinforcement or punishment. It is also a procedure that is used to bring about such learning.

Chart of Operant Conditioning

	Add to the environment +	Take away from the environment -
Behavior Increases	Positive Reinforcement	Negative Reinforcement
Behavior Decreases	Positive Punishment	Negative Punishment

44. Harmonious vs obsessive passion

Passion has two main flavors: harmonious and obsessive. Those with harmonious passion engage in their work because it brings them intrinsic joy. They have a sense of control of their work, and their work is in harmony with their other activities in life. At the same time, they know when to disengage, and are better at turning off the work switch when they wish to enjoy other activities or when further engagement becomes too risky. As a result, their work doesn't conflict with the other areas of their lives. Like those with harmonious passion, those with obsessive passion perceive their work as representing a passion for them, and view their work as highly valued. A major difference is that they have an uncontrollable urge to engage in their work. As a result, they report feeling more

conflict between their passion and the other activities in their life. Both forms of passion are associated with very different outcomes. Harmonious passion is associated with higher levels of physical health, psychological well-being, self-reported self-esteem, positive emotions, creativity, concentration, flow, work satisfaction, and increased congruence with other areas of one's life. In contrast, those with obsessive passion display higher levels of negative affect over time and display more maladaptive behaviors. They report higher levels of negative affect during and after activity engagement; they can hardly ever stop thinking about their work, and they get quite frustrated when they are prevented from working. Those with obsessive passion also have a more negative image of themselves, being quicker to pair the word "unpleasant" with "self" than those showing lower levels of obsessive passion. This suggests that their persistence doesn't come from a place of intrinsic joy, but an unstable ego.

45. PREP communication danger signs

Prevention and Relationship Program (PREP) can help you identify triggers in relationship and turn down the heat before your boil over through identifying four warning signs: 1) Escalation (when two people raise the level of negativity with each response. 2) Invalidation (when you demean the other person or minimize what they are saying). 3) Negative interpretation (when we assume the worst about someone's actions). 4) Withdrawal (when you refuse to participate in an important discussion).

46. PREP speaker-listener technique

1) Escalation (when two people raise the level of negativity with each response. *Solution is turn up the humor and speak from the heart.* 2) Invalidation (when you demean the other person or minimize what they are saying). *Solution: Speak for yourself and start conversation with 'I'.* 3) Negative interpretation (when we assume the worst about someone's actions). *Solution: The only mind to read is your own.* 4) Withdrawal (when you refuse to participate in an important discussion). *Solution: Kick the habit.*

47. Dysfunctional cycle, CBT

CBT is premised on the view that moods are created by your cognitions or thoughts. There are three assumptions therein: 1) you feel the way you do right now because of the thoughts you are thinking; 2) when you are feeling depressed your thoughts are dominated by the pervasive negativity; and 3) negative thoughts contain gross distortions. A deeper understanding of one's moods can be reached by classifying an individual's cognitive distortions into one of 10 types. One or more of these 10 cognitive distortions account for the disturbed mood. Ergo, you feel the way your think. Individuals with impaired thought processing will have self-esteem issues, wherein a trivial mistake or an imperfection may be

magnified into an overwhelming symbol of personal defeat. By substituting a rationale statement of self-defense, it is possible to recognize self-defeating thoughts as they arise, understand each as a thought distortion, and talk back to them, disarming the internal critic that dwells in your mind.

48. Thinking traps list

How we react to challenging events dictates our experiences and outcome. These reactions are often experienced as a series of thoughts that appear so spontaneously that they are called automatic or thinking traps. They are not always easy to break because we think of them as correct. Examples: jumping to conclusions, personalizing, catastrophizing, black-or-white thinking, mind reading, negative filters, labeling and should-must statement.

49. Definition of meditation

Meditation is a practice where an individual uses a technique – such as mindfulness, or focusing their mind on a particular object, thought or activity – to train attention and awareness, and achieve a mentally clear and emotionally calm and stable state.

50. Definition of mindfulness (vs mindlessness)

Mindfulness is the psychological process of bringing one's attention to experiences occurring in the present moment.

51. Procrastination

When you put off the thing you should be doing. You make this choice thinking it won't hurt you in the long run and you're right for a while. College students who procrastinate more at the beginning of a semester feel so good they actually have fewer health problems than their peers who take care of their responsibilities. By the end of the semester however, procrastinators retain less information and their grades are worse.

52. Mature defenses in therapy

In short, defense mechanisms are one of our commonest ways to cope with unpleasant emotions. Although Freud and many of his followers believed that we use them to combat sexual or aggressive feelings, defense mechanisms apply to a wide range of reactions from anxiety to insecurity. Which defense mechanism is most adaptive? In general, the more "mature" defense mechanisms include intellectualization (*you think away an emotion or reaction that you don't enjoy feeling*), sublimation (*use their emotions to fire up a cognitively-oriented response*), and rationalization (*When you rationalize something, you try to explain it away*). According to research by George Vaillant, people who use these defense mechanisms more often than the others tend to experience better family relationships and work lives. You may never rid yourself of all your defense mechanisms, but at least you can grow from understanding what they can, and cannot, do for you. Less useful defenses are denial, repression, regression, and projection.

53. How to define a mental health disorder

Mental illness refers to a wide range of mental health conditions — disorders that affect your mood, thinking and behavior. Examples of mental illness include depression, anxiety disorders, schizophrenia, eating disorders and addictive behaviors.

54. Top predictors of success in therapy

Relationship with the therapist, positive expectancy (optimism), therapist's skill, and your desire to create change.

55. Definitions of forgiveness, reconciliation

Psychologists generally define forgiveness as a conscious, deliberate decision to release feelings of resentment or vengeance toward a person or group who has harmed you, regardless of whether they actually deserve your forgiveness. Forgiveness is an internal process where you work through the hurt, gain an understanding of what happened, rebuild a sense of safety, and let go of the grudge (more on how to forgive here). The offending party is not necessarily a part of this process. When we talk about reconciliation, we are by definition talking about individuals or groups who intend by choice or necessity to remain in relationship with one another. Therefore, the faculty to confront conflicts is the ability to reconcile conflicts fair and square, thus construct a bridge of psychological strength, healing, mutual peace and good relationship.

56. Attachment theory

Attachment theory is a concept in developmental psychology that concerns the importance of "attachment" in regards to personal development. Specifically, it makes the claim that the ability for an individual to form an emotional and physical "attachment" to another person gives a sense of stability and security necessary to take risks, branch out, and grow and develop as a personality. While applicable to children, adult couples can be affected by attachments. Researchers looked at a number of couples, examining the nature of the attachments between them, and then observed how those couples reacted to various stressors and stimuli. In the case of adults, it would seem that a strong attachment is still quite important. For example, in cases where the adults had a weak attachment, there were feelings of inadequacy and a lack of intimacy on the part of both parties. When attachments were too strong, there were issues with co-dependency. The relationships functioned best when both parties managed to balance intimacy with independence. Much as is the case with developing children, the ideal situation seemed to be an attachment that functioned as a secure base from which to reach out and gain experience in the world.

57. Equity theory

Equity theory focuses on determining whether the distribution of resources is fair to both relational partners. It proposes that individuals who perceive themselves as either under-rewarded or

over-rewarded will experience distress, and that this distress leads to efforts to restore equity within the relationship. It focuses on determining whether the distribution of resources is fair to both relational partners. Equity is measured by comparing the ratios of contributions and benefits of each person within the relationship. Partners do not have to receive equal benefits (such as receiving the same amount of love, care, and financial security) or make equal contributions (such as investing the same amount of effort, time, and financial resources), as long as the ratio between these benefits and contributions is similar.

58. Ratio of positive emotions to negative emotions in relationships with others

So how much positivity do we need to have for a truly thriving existence? It appears that the ratio of 3:1 or above of positivity to negativity results in the experience of flourishing, while anything below this ratio (e.g. 2:1) – in the experience of languishing. So make sure that for every one negative emotion you have at least three positive ones. But beware, too much of even the best thing can be simply dangerous. Experiencing positivity at above 8:1 can have counterproductive effects.

Positive emotions can certainly help us on the rocky path to well-being but that does not make the negative emotions irrelevant or unimportant. They may not feel quite as good, but they can bring about very positive effects nevertheless. In defence of negative emotions, they can help initiate fundamental personality changes, facilitate learning, understanding of ourselves and knowledge of the world, and wisdom from experiencing suffering and loss that are the necessary parts of life.

59. The Transparency Illusion

The illusion of transparency is a tendency for people to overestimate the degree to which their personal mental state is known by others. Another manifestation of the illusion of transparency (sometimes called the observer's illusion of transparency) is a tendency for people to overestimate how well they understand others' personal mental states. This cognitive bias is similar to the illusion of asymmetric insight.

60. What avoiding something we're afraid of does to us

One of the most common experiences in life is feeling uneasy about a situation, and the most common reaction to anxiety is to avoid the situation. This avoidance is self-sabotage. Think about it, have you ever walked away from an important goal because it was just too hard to face your fears? I know I have. Although understanding the causes of your anxiety is important for overcoming it, the most important aspect is to focus on is how you respond to your fears. In fact, the ways that we respond to fear can often feed that fear and make it worse! By learning how you respond to anxiety and working to change those responses, you can overcome anxiety and accomplish

some very difficult goals. Avoidance can lead to negative reinforcement. Understanding negative reinforcement will help you combat fear in your daily life, and it will also help you see the same problem in other people, which may be useful at times. Negative reinforcement refers to a behavior which is rewarded because that behavior removes an unwanted stimulus or feeling.